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SUMMARY

I am a security researcher with hands-on experience in application security and competitive CTF events. My skills and expertise in this field are shaped through countless CTF competitions throughout the years. During those days I co-founded GhostSquad, a top-50 Indian CTF team as of 2024, and authored detailed write-ups that showcase expertise in domains like web, crypto, reverse engineering, and forensics. I believe that learning never stops, which is one of the reasons for why being in cyber security is so fulfilling.

EXPERIENCE

GhostSquad

Apr 2021 - Present

Co-Founder and CTF Player

- Authored detailed CTF write-ups on GitHub Pages using Markdown and Python scripts, documenting exploitation techniques and lessons learned, which helped teammates and the wider security community improve their skills
- Participated in multiple CTF competitions, applying hands-on penetration testing and vulnerability assessment skills to improve real-world security measures
- Ranked in the top 50 nationally in India in 2024, demonstrating strong practical skills across reverse engineering, web exploitation, forensics, and cryptography

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Research/Write-up blog <https://h4r1337.github.io/>

Personal

- Writes blog post about walk through of boxes from Try Hack Me and Hack The Box and other security researches topics.
- Started a CVE analysis blog series where I write root cause analysis of n-day exploits.
- Reverse engineered an android malware and reported to CERT-In.

Cyber Siege CTF Competition

Feb 2026

College of Engineering Trivandrum

- Organised an offline jeopardy style CTF competition at my college as part of the annual tech fest - INCEPTA 2026
- Built and hosted challenges using CTFd, including full infrastructure setup and deployment automation.

CERTIFICATES

- Certified Red Team Professional (CRTP): 08/2026 - 08/2029
- Certified Red Team Associate (CRTA): 06/2025 - Present
- Certified Appsec Practitioner (CAP): 04/2023 - Present

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **NCIIPC Vulnerability Disclosure Program:** Submitted multiple reports to NCIIPC (Bug Bounty program of India Government Websites)
- **Twilight Hack 2024 - 1st place:** Secured 1st place in a 24 hour national level CTF Competition
- **DomeCTF 2025 - 1st place:** Achieved first place in the DomeCTF competition at the c0c0n 2025 conference
- **IndiaSkills 2026 South Regional - Gold Medal:** Our team won the gold medal for cybersecurity at the IndiaSkills 2026 south regional competition
- **IndiaSkills 2026 Nationals - Silver Medal:** Secured silver medal for cybersecurity at the IndiaSkills 2026 national competition

LANGUAGES

- Malayalam (Native or Bilingual Proficiency)
- English (Professional Working Proficiency)
- Hindi (Conversational)

SKILLS

Security

- MetaSploit
- Nessus
- Burpsuite
- Nmap
- SAST(semgrep)
- Ghidra
- JadX
- Splunk
- Wazuh
- API Testing
- Web Application Security
- Penetration Testing
- Active Directory Security
- Enterprise Security
- Red Team

Scripting & Development

- Python
- Bash
- C/C++
- JavaScript
- API
- Flask
- Github Actions
- Gitlab CI/CD
- Docker

Standards & Framework

- OWASP Top 10
- MITRE ATT&CK

Professional Skills

- Technical Content Writing
- Reporting and Documentation

EDUCATION

Mar Ivanios College, Nalanchira

Sep 2022 - May 2025

UG

GPA: 7.48

Coursework: B.Sc. Computer Science

GHSS Poovathoor

Jun 2020 - Mar 2022

Higher Secondary

GPA: 91%

Coursework: Bio-math